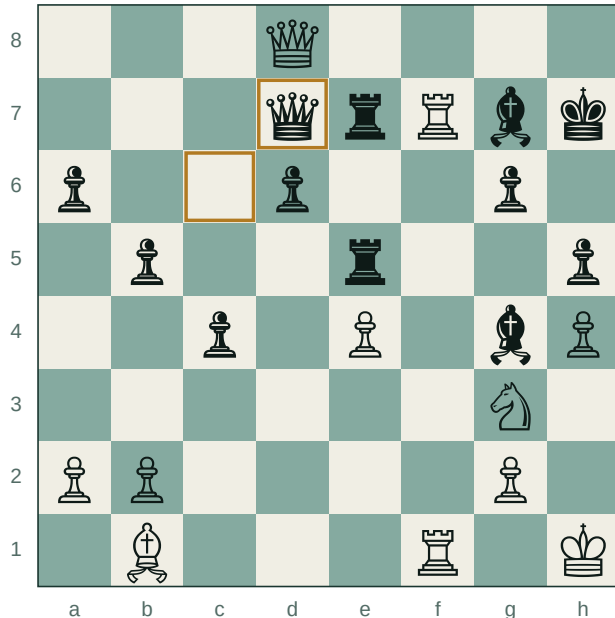


Pins and pressure: White, move 38

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Qf8 Rxf7 39. Rxf7 Qxf7 40. Qxf7

38.Qf8 The queen moves from d8 to f8. From f8 it attacks rook on e7 and bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **38...Rxf7**.

39.Rxf7 The rook captures the rook on f7. From f7 it attacks queen on d7 and bishop on g7. Recorded reply: **39...Qxf7**.

40.Qxf7 The queen captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: bishop on g7.